

ETERNAL

Employee Handbook
Your Guide to Life at Eternal

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1. A Note from Our Founders

Eternal was built on one idea: that brands with a genuine point of view outlast trends. We are a small, intentional team — and every person here shapes what we are and what we stand for. This handbook is our attempt to write down the things we'd otherwise have to repeat individually to every new person who joins. Read it, hold us accountable to it, and tell us when something feels off.

2. Who We Are

Mission: To build enduring brands that mean something — to the people who make them and the people they serve.

Our Values

- **Intentionality:** We don't move fast and break things. We think before we act, and we stand behind what we make.
- **Honesty:** With clients, with each other, and about our work — even when it's uncomfortable.
- **Generosity:** With knowledge, credit, and time. We don't hoard expertise; we share it.
- **Rigour:** We hold our creative and strategic work to a high standard. Good ideas poorly executed aren't good ideas.
- **Perspective:** We hire people with interesting points of view. We expect you to use yours.

3. How We're Organised

Eternal operates as a flat but structured organisation. We have three core functions:

- **Creative** — Brand strategy, design, copy, and production. Led by the Creative Director.
- **Client Services** — Account management, project delivery, and client relationships. Led by the Head of Client Services.
- **Operations** — Finance, people, legal, and technology. Led by the Chief Operating Officer.

The founding team (CEO, Creative Director, COO) meets weekly and makes decisions by consensus. Where consensus is not reached, the CEO has final say. Every employee has a named line manager. If you are unclear on reporting lines, ask People & Culture.

4. Code of Conduct

Working at Eternal requires a high degree of professional and personal integrity. We operate across multiple cultures and client contexts, which makes clarity of conduct especially important.

- Treat everyone — colleagues, clients, suppliers, and anyone else we interact with — with dignity and respect.
- Never share confidential client briefs, brand assets, campaign data, or internal financials with anyone outside the company.

- Do not accept gifts from clients or suppliers valued above AED 200 without disclosing them to your line manager.
- Do not use company assets, systems, or relationships for personal commercial gain.
- Social media use is personal, but posts that reference clients or projects — even vaguely — must be pre-approved by the Head of Client Services.

5. Dress Code

We work in a creative environment and expect people to dress in a way that reflects that — with intention. Our dress code is **business casual with creative latitude**. On studio days, expressive and creative dress is welcome. On client-facing days (pitches, presentations, shoots), dress should lean towards smart and polished. When in doubt, ask your account lead what the client environment is like.

6. Communication Guidelines

Internal — Microsoft Teams

Teams is our internal hub for messaging, calls, and file collaboration. Use channel conversations rather than DMs for anything project-related, so context is preserved for the team. Response time expectation during work hours is within 2 hours for messages and same-day for channel posts.

External — Email and Client Portals

All external communication with clients must go through your Eternal email address. Some clients use project portals (e.g. Asana, Monday.com) — use these as the client prefers, but always copy or log key decisions in email. Never communicate project approvals or scope changes verbally only; follow up in writing.

7. Meeting Culture

- Every meeting needs an owner, a purpose, and a time limit. No agenda = no meeting.
- Meetings should be the last resort, not the first. Async communication on Teams resolves most things faster.
- Start and finish on time. Arriving late without notice is disrespectful to the room.
- Creative reviews and client presentations require all materials shared 24 hours in advance.
- Meeting notes — including decisions and next steps — must be posted to the relevant Teams channel within the hour.
- One camera-on rule applies for all external client calls.

8. Probation Period

All new permanent employees complete a **6-month probation period**. This is structured as follows: a 30-day check-in with your line manager (informal, no documentation), a 90-day review with HR present (formal, documented), and a final probation review at month 6. Successful completion is confirmed in writing. The company may extend probation by up to 2 months where the outcome is unclear. Employees on probation do not qualify for remote working.

9. Raising a Complaint or Grievance

We take all concerns seriously and handle them with discretion. If you have a complaint:

- 1 **Speak Up Early:** If you feel safe doing so, raise the issue directly with the person involved or your line manager. Early conversations often prevent escalation.
- 2 **Formal Submission:** If you are unable to resolve the matter informally, email people@eternal.ae with a written account. HR will acknowledge within one business day.
- 3 **Investigation:** An impartial HR lead will be assigned. You will be interviewed, and the other party/parties will be given an opportunity to respond. Confidentiality will be maintained throughout.
- 4 **Outcome and Appeal:** A written outcome will be provided within 15 working days. You may appeal within 7 working days if you believe the process was not followed correctly.

Anonymous reports may also be submitted via the independently operated Ethics Hotline, details of which are on the intranet.